

Dinner lacked highest security level

Suspect called himself ‘friendly federal assassin’

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK, PERRY STEIN, N. KIRKPATRICK AND EMILY DAVIES

He identified himself in a mis- sive sent to family members moments before the attack as a “friendly federal assassin” and railed against Trump administra- tion policies. He booked a hotel room at the Washington Hilton weeks in advance, then traveled by train from his home outside Los Angeles to Chicago and then to D.C.

And as he stormed the security perimeter at the White House correspondents’ dinner Saturday, exchanging gunfire with Secret Service agents, the 31-year-old suspected shooter aimed to target top officials, including possibly the president himself, law en- forcement officials said.

Those details about the man involved in the shooting that forced the evacuation of Presi- dent Donald Trump and several members of his cabinet from the ritzy annual event emerged Sunday as investigators on two coasts worked to gather information on the suspected gunman and what motivated his attack.

Though officials have not pub- SEE GUNMAN ON A8

‘Get down, get down!’ followed by chaos

BY DAN DIAMOND, CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, EMILY DAVIES AND MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

Plates clanged, glasses clinked, and at the front of the room sat President Donald Trump, making his long-awaited return to the White House Corre- spondents’ Association dinner on Saturday.

It was just after 8:30 p.m., in the basement of the Washington Hilton. The president was on- stage, locked in conversation with CBS reporter Weijia Jiang; spread out in front of them were thousands of attendees, seated at more than 250 tables, as waiters cleared away their salads.

Then loud popping sounds were heard from the lobby. “I thought it was a tray going down,” Trump would say later.

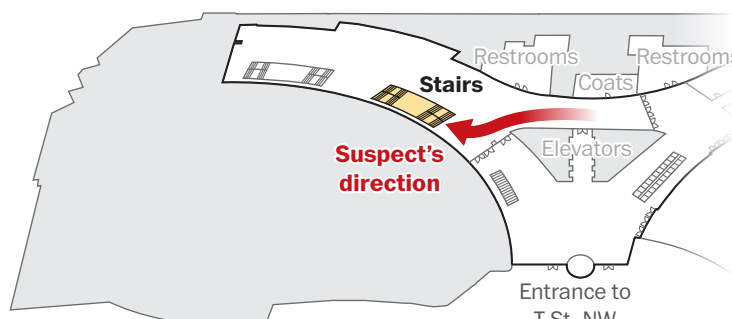
For the third time in less than two years, Trump found himself under the threat of gunfire. Hun- dreds of people — table after SEE SHOOTING ON A9



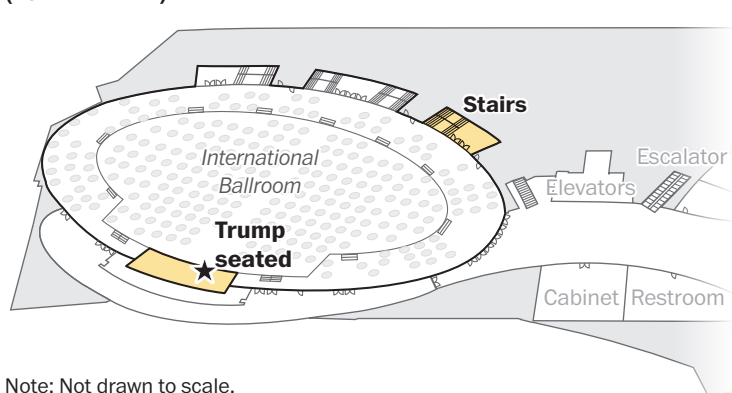
JONATHAN ERNST/REUTERS

Suspect reached stairs to ballroom

TERRACE LEVEL (UPPER LEVEL)



CONCOURSE LEVEL (LOWER LEVEL)



Note: Not drawn to scale. Source: Washington Hilton



TOM BRENNER/AP

TOP: House Speaker Mike Johnson is evacuated as a shooter opens fire at the White House correspondents’ dinner on Saturday. **ABOVE:** President Donald Trump, who was quickly escorted from the scene, arrives to speak at the White House after the incident.

More coverage inside

Eyewitness: A Post reporter recounts what it was like on the scene. **A7**
Ballroom: Shooting used to justify Trump’s pet project for White House. **A8**
Suspect’s path: Alleged gunman sprinted past security checkpoint. **A10**

Mood in Russia bleak as war drags on and economy stalls

BY CATHERINE BELTON AND NATALIA ABBAKUMOVA

President Vladimir Putin is facing rising discontent across Russian society as the war against Ukraine drags on, the economy flounders and public dissatisfaction mounts over govern- ment restrictions on internet access.

Russia’s biggest state-owned pollster, the Russian Public Opin- ion Research Center, on Friday recorded that Putin’s approval rating fell to 65.6 percent, its lowest level since before the be- ginning of the war and a drop of 12.2 percentage points since the start of the year.

Gauging genuine public opin- ion is difficult under an authori- tarian regime that exiles, impris- ons or even kills political oppo- nents and where criticism of the war is illegal, but compared with Putin’s historical ratings — as high as 88 percent — the falling poll numbers signal growing weariness with the war now in its fifth year, and with negotiations to end it largely stalled as the Trump administration focuses on Iran.

Economic sanctions are biting ever deeper into Russia’s econo- my, hitting pocketbooks, and the government’s push to limit ac- cess to the internet, citing securi- ty concerns, is rankling a society

SEE RUSSIA ON A13

Marathon milestone shattered



IAN WALTON/AP

Kenya’s Sebastian Sawe wins the London Marathon in 1 hour, 59 minutes and 30 seconds Sunday as two African runners became the first to break the 2-hour barrier in the 26.2-mile distance. **Sports, C2**

With Powell probe quashed, Tillis clears path for Warsh

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN

Sen. Thom Tillis (R-North Carolina) said Sunday he was satisfied that the Justice Depart- ment ended its criminal investi- gation into Federal Reserve Chair Jerome H. Powell, clearing the way for Republicans to ad- vance President Donald Trump’s pick to be the next leader of the central bank, Kevin Warsh.

“I am prepared to move on with the confirmation of Mr. Warsh,” Tillis said on NBC’s “Meet the Press.”

Tillis had previously criticized the probe as an effort to pressure Powell to resign early and to erode the Fed’s ability to set

interest rates free from White House interference. On Sunday, Tillis said he had assurances from officials that the case would be reopened only if the Fed’s internal watchdog found evidence of criminal wrongdoing.

Tillis’s announcement re- moved the last major obstacle to Warsh’s confirmation, setting up what could be a decisive week for the Fed’s future leadership. The Senate Banking Committee is scheduled to vote Wednesday on whether to advance the nomina- tion to the full Senate.

“He is an outstanding nomi- nee, and it is time for the Federal SEE TILLIS ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Big payouts Justice Department payments to resolve legal claims by Trump allies and supporters could undermine cases brought before his return to the White House. **A4**

A ‘gift back to Mom’ Ben’s Chili Bowl hopes that its Friday reopening will meet the high standards of family matriarch Virginia Ali. **C7**

THE NATION **Utility companies** shut off Americans’ power 13.4 million times in 2024, a report says. **A3**
A bill would halt pen- sion payments to federal legislators convicted of specific crimes. **A5**

THE WORLD **For Flávio Bolsonaro,** Jair Bolsonaro’s son, a presidential bid in Brazil is personal. **A11**
Pakistani officials say indirect ceasefire talks between the U.S. and Iran are ongoing. **A12**

THE ECONOMY **A plan** to extend health care to more than 40,000 children was approved by Florida lawmakers in 2023 but has since stalled. **A16**
E.U. leaders consider funding alternative energy routes in the Middle East to circum- vent hot spots. **A16**

STYLE **Carter Faith** is poised to be a breakout country star even though she has yet to release a single for radio airplay. **B1**

SPORTS **The Nats’ 33-year-old manager** has built a rapport with his young team during the first month of the season. **C1**

THE REGION **Pedestrians** walking near D.C. schools are more likely to be hit by a vehicle than those else- where in the city. **C7**

HEALTH & SCIENCE **A study** put AI chatbots to the test with 250 questions about health. They got almost half the answers wrong. **D1**

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